ARAVIND NATARAJAN

Quality Assurance Manager | *Test Automation & AI-Assisted QA* | *Release Governance*
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quality Assurance Manager with nearly a decade across **Amazon**, **Brightcove** and a **0-to-1 mandate** at a Series A grocery-delivery platform that raised $11M+. Turns ambiguous, early-stage QA problems into **governed, AI-accelerated processes** that protect product quality and scale testing efficiency. Has built a QA function from zero, led teams of 10+, owned quality for launches across 18 locales and enterprise accounts like Spotify and BBC, and taken a startup from daily hotfixes to planned, predictable releases.

QUALITY IMPACT AT A GLANCE

75%+ to under 20% defect leakage (year 1) | **10h to 4h** regression cycle | **84% leaner** regression suite
Under 1% invalid defects | **Daily hotfixes to a predictable** release cadence | **$69K+** cumulative annual savings

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BUNCHA | Remote | May 2025 – Sep 2026

Quality Assurance Manager

US-based grocery delivery platform (Series A, $11M+ raised)

- **Established 0-to-1 QA governance**, taking a startup from daily hotfixes to a predictable weekly / bi-weekly release cadence across 150+ releases by defining team ownership, SDLC release gates, mandatory sign-offs and a P0–P3 severity framework.
- **Cut defect leakage from 75%+ to under 20% within a year** and app crashes 85%, lifting defect removal efficiency from under 25% to over 80%.
- **Led end-to-end QA strategy for the Meijer rollout** (3 stores at launch, 13 today), aligning product roadmaps, engineering deliverables and executive deadlines to ship 1-hour delivery on schedule (~370 daily orders, $5,000+ daily revenue), alongside 30+ initiatives including DoorDash and Uber integrations.
- **Built and led a 4-person QA team, including a QA Lead,** reporting to the Head of Product and later the CEO in a 35-person tech org: hiring, onboarding, KPIs, reviews and growth plans, holding release cadence through an unbacked headcount reduction.
- **Shifted quality left** with a standing seat on the executive release-priority panel and company-wide PRD reviews, catching architectural defects before development.
- **Cut SOS escalations ~80%** (4–6 a week to 3–4 a month) by authoring a company-wide incident-severity framework adopted by Support, SRE and Engineering, and securing a dedicated after-hours SRE hire.
- **Designed the release and team tracking behind go/no-go calls and leadership reporting**, refined over months of observation: release readiness, escape rate, DRE, bug SLA and capacity (demo-data version in portfolio).

  AI-assisted tools built (1,300+ engineering hours and $14,800 reclaimed a year):

  - **Bytecast** (live on the Chrome Web Store): Claude-powered extension that files complete bug reports (video, logs, network, steps) into Jira, ClickUp and 8 other trackers in one click.
  - **FlowForge** (built with AI): Android app that records user flows and generates pytest + Appium 2 Page Object scripts, with GitHub PR export and AI review of flaky locators and missing assertions.
  - **Test-order admin tool:** admin UI pulling live production and Elasticsearch data to create test orders in under 1 min (from ~18), removing a ~$30 per-order cost; adopted company-wide for in-store trials and extended into Greenhouse onboarding.
  - **Unified alerting platform:** co-built with SRE a single view of New Relic, Datadog, Redis and RabbitMQ alerts across environments, exposing two runaway services and eliminating ~100K redundant daily service calls.

BRIGHTCOVE | Chennai, India | Dec 2021 – Mar 2025

Quality Assurance Engineer (APAC QA Lead)

Global video and OTT streaming platform

- **Directed APAC QA strategy solo** as a founding member of Brightcove's India professional services team and the region's only QA engineer, **leading and mentoring 4 contractors** beyond formal scope across 10 enterprise accounts (Spotify, AT&T, BBC, Cisco, Dell, ExxonMobil, GM).
- **Cut recurring issues by over half and invalid defects 40%** by building a root-cause and triage process from scratch.
- **Saved $40,000+ a year, cut production rollbacks by over half and raised CSAT 20%** across 50+ projects, including 5 large enterprise launches, by establishing pre-production test gates and holding back releases that were not ready.
- **Cut regression from 10h to 4h per cycle**, reclaiming 20+ hours per release, through a risk-based strategy built with product (30% fewer test cases).

- Owned testing across web, mobile, Android TV and admin consoles plus customer data migrations; set up a central Xray repository (~4 hours saved per project); recognized by the Director, a Senior VP and clients.

AMAZON | Chennai, India | Dec 2019 – Dec 2021

Sr. Associate, Quality Service

- **Led a team of 10+ QA associates** across 6 concurrent projects and 28+ features, partnering daily with US leadership, developers and TPMs; cut new-hire onboarding from 9 weeks to under 4, lifting team efficiency 30%.
- **Delivered zero launch-blocking auth defects** across 18 locales and 20+ devices (Echo, Fire TV, Bose, Sony) as a founding member of Alexa Identity QA, and owned Alexa Presence testing with the Seattle development team.
- **Redesigned the core regression suite from 1,100 to 180 cases**, bringing a full cycle to 1 day, saving $15,000 a year and raising test efficiency 40%.
- **Dropped invalid defects under 1% and cut resolution time 20%** by rewriting defect standards across 950+ critical bugs and 2,000+ test cases.
- **Automated daily reporting and bug filing**: reporting from 2h to 20 min (400+ hours a year) and bug entry from 5 min to 1 click (800+ hours over two years).

AMAZON | Chennai, India | Jun 2017 – Dec 2019

Associate, Quality Service

- **Prevented critical launch blockers** by streamlining weekly regression for the Alexa mobile app across Android, iOS and Fire Tablets.
- Grew ownership of one app area into **full end-to-end Alexa Identity validation**.
- Earned **9 company awards in 2.5 years** (including Star of the Month and Quarterback Champion) and a fast-track promotion to Sr. Associate.

CORE SKILLS & TOOLS

- **QA Leadership & Strategy:** Test Strategy, Test Planning & Estimation, SDLC & STLC, Shift-Left Testing, Risk-Based Testing, Release Management & Go/No-Go, Incident Governance (P0–P3), Defect Management, Process Improvement, Hiring & Interviewing (40+ candidates), Mentoring, Contractor & Vendor Management, Cross-functional & Distributed (Onshore-Offshore) Teams, Agile & Scrum
- **Test Automation & Performance:** Automation Strategy, Selenium (JavaScript), AI-generated test scripts (Appium 2 / pytest, Page Object Model via FlowForge), API Testing (Postman, REST, Swagger), CI/CD (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), BDD (Gherkin), Performance & Load Testing (JMeter), Tampermonkey scripting (JavaScript)
- **Quality Metrics & Reporting:** Defect leakage / escape rate, Defect removal efficiency (DRE), Test coverage, Invalid-defect rate, Regression cycle time, Production rollbacks, MTTR, CSAT, Quality dashboards
- **AI in QA:** Team-wide Claude rollout (reusable prompts, priority matrices), AI-assisted test generation (FlowForge), LLM-based defect triage (Bytecast), LLM output evaluation, AI-assisted tool development (Android app, Chrome extension), Claude API, Claude Code, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Prompt Engineering
- **Testing & Platforms:** Functional, Regression, E2E, UAT, Exploratory, Compatibility, Accessibility (a11y), Localization, Cross-platform & OTT, Test Data Management; Mobile (iOS, Android, React Native), Web, Android TV and OTT (Fire TV, Apple TV, Roku, Smart TVs), Microservices; Mobile debugging (adb, logcat, network proxies such as Charles and mitmproxy); BrowserStack, LambdaTest; SQL
- **Tools:** Jira (JQL, dashboards, automation rules), Xray, TestRail, ClickUp, Confluence, Zapier, Git, GitHub, Jenkins; Datadog, New Relic (NRQL), Metabase, Redis, RabbitMQ, Elasticsearch

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Electronics and Communication Engineering | Sri Krishna College of Engineering and Technology | CGPA 8.13

- Six Sigma Yellow Belt Certified
- Anthropic Academy: Claude API, Model Context Protocol, Claude Code and Agent Skills (2026)
- ISTQB Foundation Level (CTFL): in progress, exam planned Jan 2027